

How Birthday Club App drove 2,662 app installs and cut cost per install by 47%

From an account with zero properly optimized install campaigns to 2,662 app installs across two markets, with cost per install falling from \$7.36 to \$3.90 through campaign restructuring and systematic creative testing.

Client Birthday Club App

Markets Twin Cities, MN & Berrien County, MI

Industry Restaurant deals / dining rewards

Service Paid social (Meta Ads, app installs)

2,662

TOTAL APP INSTALLS

\$3.90

BEST COST PER
INSTALL

47%

CPI REDUCTION

493K

TOTAL REACH

THE CHALLENGE

An account built on the wrong foundation

Birthday Club App aggregates birthday deals, free desserts and meal discounts from local restaurants into a single mobile app. The B2C app install drives consumer adoption, while restaurants pay subscription fees to be featured. When we took over the account, the app had been running paid media for over a year with zero app install campaigns.

An 87-point audit found structural problems throughout. The account was running only traffic ads and one low-budget lead ad, both on the wrong optimization objective. All languages were targeted instead of English only. There were no retargeting, custom or lookalike audiences. Campaigns were optimized for traffic instead of installs, and ads pointed to a restaurant subdomain rather than the app store. Every dollar spent had been working against the client's actual business objective.

THE STRATEGY

Rebuilt from scratch with systematic testing

We rebuilt the campaign architecture from the ground up with proper app install campaigns and correct optimization objectives. The strategy centered on systematic creative testing: 8 creatives run through 6 rounds of CPC analysis to identify the top performers.

We built birthday-targeting audiences and A/B tested birthday-specific against broad targeting, segmented by gender and market. Women-only targeting outperformed in Berrien County, while both genders performed well in the Twin Cities. Campaign consolidation was critical: we killed the underperforming DEALS campaign, consolidated into CELEBRATIONS, turned off retargeting that was running at a \$10.22 cost per install, and reduced from more than five fragmented campaigns to two or three focused ones. Weekly monitoring and creative rotation kept performance consistent, with creative refreshed before it degraded.

Meta Ads

App install campaigns

Creative testing

Campaign consolidation

Birthday targeting

Multi-market strategy

THE RESULTS

From broken campaigns to voluntary budget increases

The restructured campaigns cut cost per install from \$7.36 to \$3.90, a 47% reduction. During the peak scaling period, installs grew 46.8% month over month, from 503 to 738 in a single 30-day window. Across the campaign lifetime we drove 2,662 app installs and reached 493,484 people across 41 campaigns, on approximately \$13,300 in total spend, a blended cost per install of roughly \$5.00.

75% budget increase. The client voluntarily raised monthly budget from \$2,000 to \$3,500 with no persuasion needed.

CAMPAIGN PERFORMANCE

Active campaign breakdown by market

Each market received tailored targeting, creative and budget allocation based on performance data. The Twin Cities served as the primary market, with Berrien County as the expansion test.

CAMPAIGN	INSTALLS	CPI	REACH	FREQUENCY
Berrien County 12/26	135	\$3.90	18,712	3.28
Twin Cities Women	185	\$4.31	10,387	4.13
Twin Cities Men	140	\$4.17	10,431	2.77
Berrien County Women	15	\$5.31	1,398	3.71

Internal campaign labels. These are the campaigns active at the time of reporting, not the full set of 41 campaigns that produced the 2,662 lifetime installs.

CREATIVE TESTING

Systematic creative optimization

Eight creatives were tested across six rounds of CPC analysis. Gender-specific winners emerged, which allowed precise targeting per market.

CREATIVE	WINNING AUDIENCE	MARKET	OUTCOME
Pink background, woman	Men	Both markets	Top CPC performer for male audiences
Yellow background, woman	Women	Both markets	Top CPC performer for female audiences
DEALS campaign	—	—	Killed, underperforming
Retargeting	—	—	Turned off at \$10.22 CPI

THE SCALING STORY

From one market to two

We expanded from the Twin Cities, Minnesota into Berrien County, Michigan as a second test market, adapting the strategy per market with different winning creatives, different gender targeting and different budget allocations. When Berrien County costs began rising, budget was rebalanced to \$1,200 for the Twin Cities and \$800 for Berrien County, and new creatives were deployed rather than letting performance degrade.

The account went from zero properly optimized campaigns to a structure where the client was voluntarily increasing spend month over month.